

NETFLIX

Project Report: Content Strategy

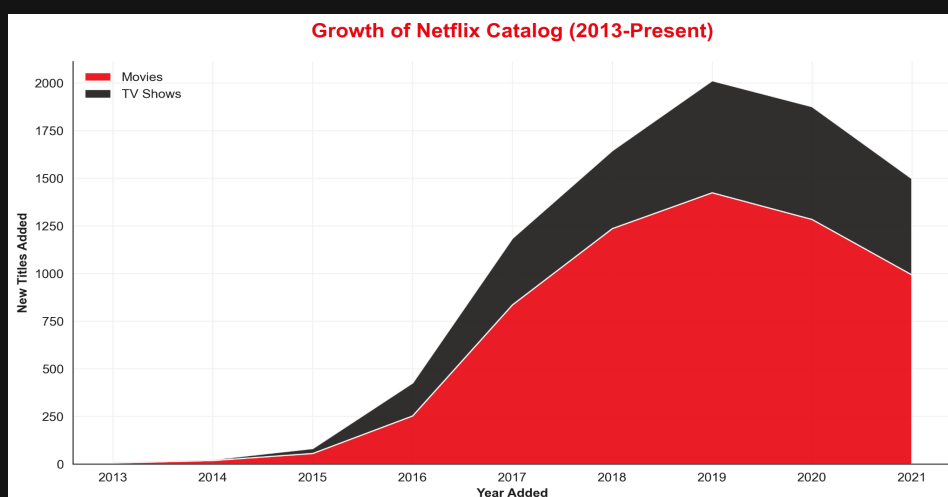
Analysis Author: Krishna Varshney

Tools: Python (Pandas, Seaborn, Plotly)

Dataset: Netflix Global Catalog (8,807 Titles)

Executive Summary

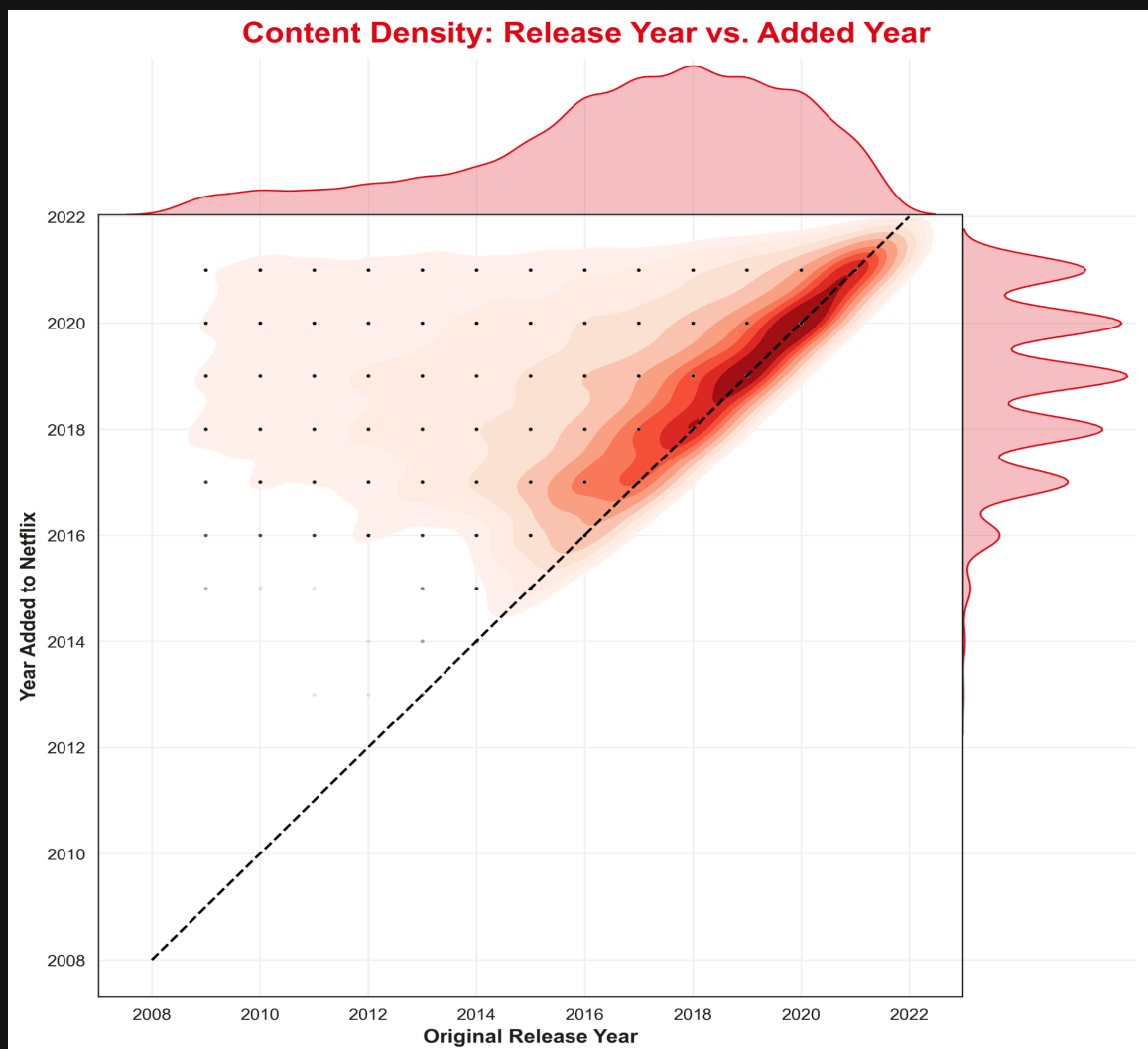
This project analyzes Netflix's catalog evolution over the last decade to understand how the streaming giant pivoted from a content aggregator to a global production powerhouse. By examining over 8,000 titles, the analysis uncovers three key strategic pillars: a shift toward "Originals" to reduce licensing reliance, aggressive hyper-localization in Asian markets (specifically India), and a focus on high-retention Adult dramas over family-friendly content.



Key Insights & Findings

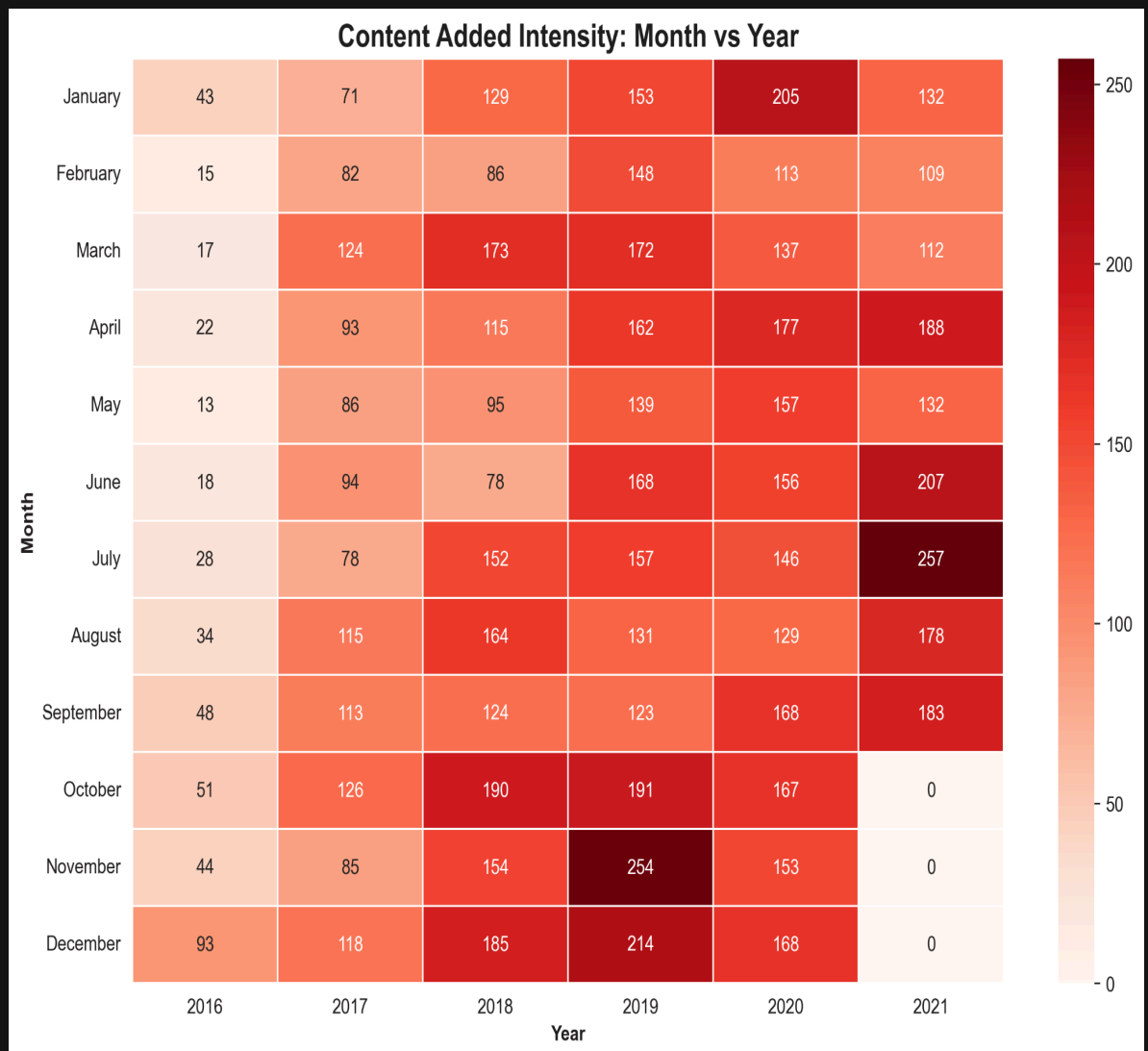
The "Originals" Pivot (Content Strategy)

- The Shift: Prior to 2016, Netflix functioned primarily as a digital archive for older movies (high lag between "Release Year" and "Added Year").
- The Pivot: Post-2016, the data shows a dramatic reduction in this lag time. The "Content Lag" density plot reveals a massive concentration of titles released and added in the same year, confirming the aggressive strategy to compete directly with cinema releases via Netflix Originals.



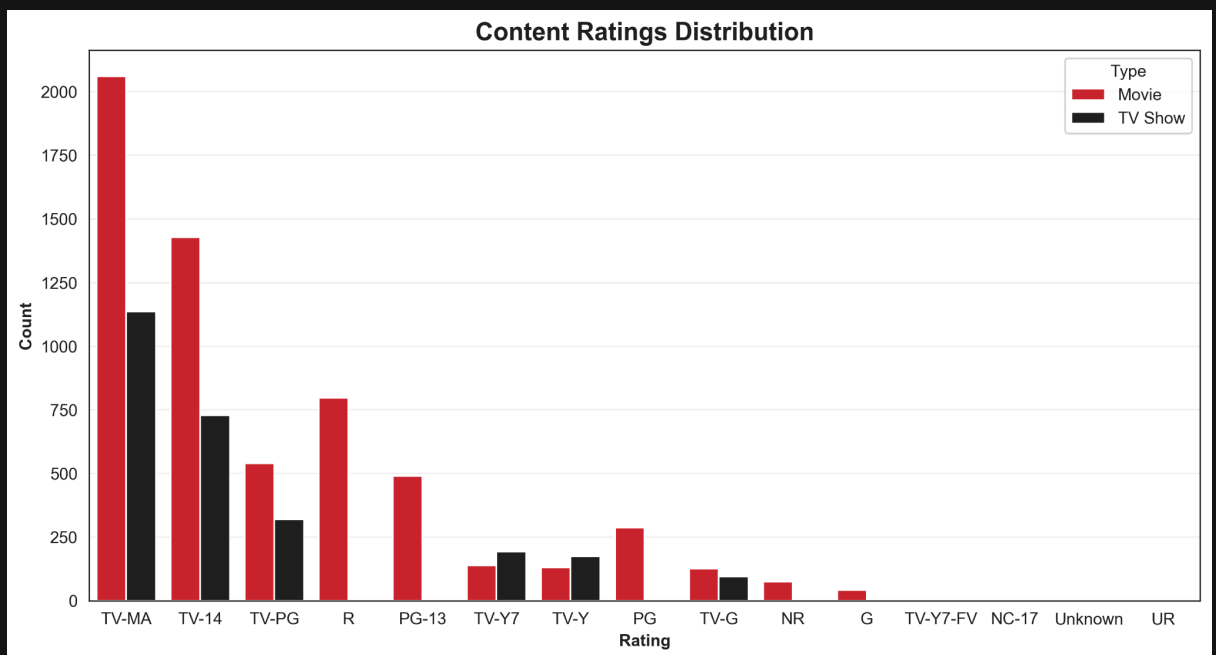
Global Expansion (The "Next Billion" Users)

- **US Dominance:** The United States remains the primary content engine, contributing over 3,600 titles.
- **The India Bet:** India has emerged as the #2 content contributor, surpassing the UK and South Korea. However, the Indian catalog is heavily skewed (90% Movies vs. 10% TV Shows), unlike the more balanced US catalog. This highlights a strategy of acquiring high-volume Bollywood licenses to capture the massive Indian user base.



Audience Targeting (Adults vs. Kids)

- **Maturity Split:** The platform is heavily skewed toward mature audiences. Over 65% of the catalog is rated TV-MA or R.
- **The Family Gap:** Content rated for "Kids" (TV-Y, G) represents a minor fraction of the library. This suggests Netflix is positioning itself as a premium "HBO-like" service for adults, likely ceding the pure family demographic to competitors like Disney+.



Retention Mechanics (The "Binge" Formula)

- **The "One-Season" Churn:** Over 60% of TV Shows end after Season 1. This points to a high-risk, high-reward strategy where Netflix pilots many concepts but ruthlessly cancels underperformers to free up budget for new viral hits.
- **Seasonality:** Content releases spike consistently in July (Summer) and December (Holidays), strategically timing "Event TV" to minimize churn during high-viewership windows.

